

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/8: Realist system map

NYĀYA: valid knowledge and argument VAIŚEṢIKA: inventory of reality

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+----- NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA -----+

realism + pluralism + liberation through truth

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valid cognition (pramā) -> objects correctly known -> false notions removed -> faults cease

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karma-producing action ceases -> rebirth and pain cease -> RELEASE (apavarga).

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/8: Seven categories (padārthas)

1. DRAVYA (padārtha): substance, separable and knowable

1 DRAVYA: earth, water, fire, air, ākāśa, time, space, self, mind

2 CONSTITUENT QUALITY (guṇa): quality; depends on substance, does not itself possess quality/action

3 ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (karma): motion/action in a substance

4 SĀMĀNYA: real universal, one-in-many

5 VIŚEṢA: ultimate particularity individuating eternal atoms and selves

6 INHERENCE (samavāya): eternal inherence; whole-parts, universal-particular, quality-substance

7 ABSENCE (abhāva): absence – prior, posterior, mutual, absolute

CAUTION: inherence (samavāya) is not conjunction (saṃyoga), which is separable.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/8: Four means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) and perception

MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇas)

- +> perception (pratyakṣa): sense-object contact -> nirvikalpaka -> savikalpaka recognition
- +> inference (anumāna): sign (liṅga/hetu) through invariable concomitance (vyāpti) to property to be proved (sādhya)
- +> comparison (upamāna): knowledge through similarity and prior description
- +> verbal testimony (śabda): trustworthy utterance, ultimately āpta testimony

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PERCEPTION TYPES: external/internal | ordinary/alaukika

alaukika: sāmānyalakṣaṇa, jñānalakṣaṇa, yogaja

ERROR is mislocation of a real qualifier: misplacement theory of error (anyathākhyāti).

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/8: Inference engine

SVARTHĀNUMĀNA: inference for oneself | PARARTHĀNUMĀNA: demonstrated to another

five members:

1 pratijñā: hill has fire

2 reason (hetu): because it has smoke

3 udāharaṇa: wherever smoke, fire – as kitchen

4 upanaya: hill has such smoke

5 nigamana: therefore hill has fire

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pakṣadharmatā + invariable concomitance (vyāpti) + uncontradicted application -> conclusion

HETVĀBHĀSA: savyabhicāra, viruddha, satpratipakṣa, asiddha, bādhita.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/8: Causation and atomism

NON-EXISTENCE OF THE EFFECT BEFORE PRODUCTION (asatkāryavāda) / NEW PRODUCTION (ārambhavāda):

effect is a new beginning, not pre-existent as effect

causes: samavāyi (inherent) | asamavāyi (non-inherent) | nimitta (efficient)

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earth/water/fire/air atom (paramāṇu) -> dyad -> triad -> gross composite

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pralaya: composites dissolve; eternal atoms, selves, space, time remain

śṛṣṭi: Lord (Īśvara) activates atoms according to unseen causal force (adṛṣṭa)/action and moral consequence (karma)

TRAP: God orders atoms; God is not the material cause and atoms are not created ex nihilo.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/8: Self, God and liberation

ENDURING SELF (Ātman): eternal, many, all pervasive substrate of cognition, desire and volition

SENSORY MIND (manas): atomic inner sense linking self to one cognition at a time

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LORD (Īśvara): eternal omniscient efficient cause; author/teacher of Veda;
coordinates atoms and karmic deserts without abolishing individual agency

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true knowledge -> doṣa removed -> pravṛtti ceases -> action and moral consequence (karma)
exhausted -> release (apavarga)

release (apavarga) = complete cessation of pain; classical Nyāya does not define it as
Brahman-union.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/8: Proof, objection and comparison

UDAYANA ROUTES: kāryāt (effect) | āyogjanāt (combination) | dhṛtyādeḥ (support)

padāt (word-use) | pratyayataḥ (trust) | śruteḥ (Veda) | vākyaāt (sentences)

saṃkhyāviśeṣāt (number) | adṛṣṭāt (moral order)

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OBJECTION: atoms + action and moral consequence (karma) may make God redundant; bodies expose unequal suffering

REPLY: unconscious atoms/unseen causal force (adṛṣṭa) cannot intelligently initiate and allocate order

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SĀMḲHYA: pre-existence of the effect in the cause (satkāryavāda), primordial material nature (prakṛti) material cause | NYĀYA: new effect from atoms

BUDDHISM: momentary process | NYĀYA: enduring substances and selves.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/8: PYQ answer spine

DEFINE realist pluralist synthesis -> list seven categories with relations

- > four means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) -> perception stages -> five-member inference
- > misplacement theory of error (anyathākhyāti) -> self/sensory mind (manas) -> Lord (Īśvara) proofs and objection
- > new production (ārambhavāda) + three causes -> atomistic creation cycle
- > release (apavarga) -> compare Sāṃkhya/Buddhism -> qualified verdict

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VERDICT: the system gains explanatory integration from realism and logical method;
its pressure points are inherence, the leap from order to God, and austere liberation.